AERO AXIS LINK

The Lift Test: Methodology v1.0

How we judge whether cargo could pay its way at an East African airstrip. Open method, public sources, corrections welcome.

WHY THIS EXISTS

Most freight in East Africa moves by road, and for most goods that is the right answer. Air freight pays only when goods are worth a lot per kilogram or cannot wait. The Lift Test asks seven questions to find where an airstrip makes that difference, and what would have to be true for cargo to work. A low score is not a failure: many strips do something more important than cargo, such as keeping people connected and safe.

THE SEVEN QUESTIONS (SCORE EACH 0, 1 OR 2)

Question	0 (weak)	1 (conditional)	2 (strong)
1 Value density	Bulk or low-value goods only	Some high-value niches	Clear high-value flow
2 Time sensitivity	Goods can wait	Some goods cannot wait	Most targeted goods lose value fast
3 Road gap	Road is fast and reliable	Meaningful but narrowing gap	Days saved, or road often cut
4 Anchor demand	None identified	Possible anchor, volume unknown	Named anchor, regular volume
5 Backhaul	One direction only	Imbalanced	Balanced two-way flow
6 Passenger base	No scheduled service	Occasional or new service	Established regular service
7 Aircraft fit	Limits most aircraft	Small aircraft only	Comfortable for likely aircraft

EVIDENCE TAGS

- **S** sourced: from a named public document.
- **E** estimate: our reasoning from public information.
- **?** unknown: shown as an open question, never scored as zero.

BANDS

11 to 14 Cargo-led

7 to 10 Conditional

0 to 6 People-first

RULES WE KEEP

- Every score is published with its conditions: what would have to be true.
- Public sources only. We cite them in the caption.
- Validation partners (authorities, operators) check facts, not conclusions or scores.
- Sponsors, if any, never see scores before publication or influence them. Commercial relationships are disclosed on the content.
- Corrections are welcome and are logged below, with the date.

WORKED EXAMPLE (DRAFT, FROM PUBLIC INFORMATION)

Strip	Scores (Q1 to Q7)	Total	Band
Lodwar	1, 2, 1, 1, 1, 2, 1	9 / 14	Conditional
Kerenga	1, 1, 0, 0, 1, 1, 2	6 / 14	People-first (provisional)

VERSION AND CORRECTIONS LOG

Date	Version	Change or correction	Source
Oct 2026	1.0	First publication. Equal weighting. Draft scores for Lodwar and Kerenga.	Aero Axis Link